

THE JAYS WAY

Creighton Volleyball - 2026 Edition



BEING A TEAM

- Being a team requires a commitment. It takes continuous effort to cultivate the relationships within a team. We are not talking about the talent or skill level necessary to be a successful team. We are talking about the type of community we are developing—the culture. In this case, it is the Creighton Volleyball Team.





BEING A TEAM

- We speak endlessly about chemistry. Our skills we will work on. Our chemistry and community (culture) should always be developed, both on and off the court. Don't underestimate its strength (positive or negative) and don't take it for granted. The best way to build chemistry is by a common understanding that the team comes first. Humility is not thinking less of yourself; it's thinking of yourself less. Inclusion is ingrained in who we are – be direct in inviting and making everyone feel a part of the team. When you look back at your experiences, you will remember the relationships and whatever success we are able to achieve as a team.



BEING TRUTHFUL

Trust is the foundation of any relationship and within a team it is essential to be able to operate and interact effectively in order to achieve our goals. Not to be confused with being blunt, being truthful helps build trust even when dealing with tough situations. So being truthful isn't solely a moral obligation, it is also a necessity for us to function as a team.

FILLING THE BUCKET

- Each of us has an invisible bucket. It is consistently emptied or filled, depending on what others say or do to us or what we say to ourselves. When our bucket is full, we feel great. When it's empty, we feel awful.
- Each of us also has an invisible dipper. When we use that dipper to fill our own or other people's buckets—by saying or doing things to increase their positive emotions we also fill our own bucket. But when we use that dipper to dip from our own or others' buckets, we diminish ourselves.





FILLING THE BUCKET

- Like a cup that runs over, a full bucket gives us a positive outlook and renewed energy. Every drop in that bucket makes us stronger and more optimistic. But an empty bucket poisons our outlook, saps our energy and undermines our will. That's why every time someone dips from our bucket it hurts us.
- So, we face a choice every moment of every day: We can fill one another's buckets, or we can dip from them. It's an important choice—one that profoundly influences our relationships, productivity, health and happiness.



DOING THINGS WITH PURPOSE

We aren't here to waste anyone's time. Put in effort, not hours! The coaching staff envisions an efficient use of time where everyone is contributing to a well-run, productive practice. This means that all players are on time, ready to begin (shoes are on, tape on the court, pre-training is completed, gym is clean, etc.)

A group of female volleyball players in blue jerseys are celebrating on a court. They are jumping and raising their arms in the air. The background shows a large crowd of spectators in a gymnasium. The text "DOING THINGS WITH PURPOSE" is overlaid on the right side of the image.

DOING THINGS WITH PURPOSE

When you arrive to the court, you grab a ball and get prepared for practice. When we corner up to begin practice, we are listening, making eye contact and preparing to begin training. The same goes for listening to drills so that we can focus on improving strategy and execution rather than how the drill is conducted.

BEING THANKFUL

Just as most people don't see the thousands of hours in the gym you put in to become a Division I athlete, don't take for granted the work that goes into making this a first-rate program (marketing, compliance, athletic training, strength and conditioning, facilities, ticketing, academics, managers/practice players, etc.). This also extends to saying "thank you" to bus drivers, restaurant servers, coaches for paying for meals, and so on.



BREAKING BARRIERS

Sometimes the greatest hindrance in achieving something that has never been done is purely in your mind. The 4-minute mile was something that runners strived to reach for decades. It was truly the Holy Grail of Athletic Achievement. However, on May 6, 1954, Roger Bannister did what some said could never be done. He ran the mile in 3:59.4, breaking the 4-minute mark. However, what happened after was the most fascinating. The barrier that runners couldn't break for decades was broken by another runner just 3 months after Bannister. Just a year after Bannister's run, 3 more runners broke 4 minutes in one race! Now running a mile under 4 minutes is still an amazing accomplishment, but something runners believe is attainable.



STORYTELLING

- *"Do you find yourself making excuses when you do not perform? Shed the excuses and face reality. Excuses are the loser's way out. They will mar your credibility and stunt your personal growth."* - Alexander Pope
- For as hard as we try, there are times when we fail. Failures are not just on the court but can also occur in everyday life as a student and as a human. At times, these are collective failures and other times they are individual failures. "Storytelling" is when you make excuses for yourself or others instead of owning your own actions.



STORYTELLING

- “We lost that match because the officials were terrible!”
- “The travel for this trip was soooo bad. The flight was delayed, and the bus wasn’t on time to pick us up for the match...”
- “If I hadn’t broken up with my significant other, I would not have failed that exam.”
- Excuses tend to get in the way of reality. Tell no stories for your failures – own it. “You can make excuses, or you can make progress. You choose.” -Brian Tracy

FRUSTRATION INTO CONFIDENCE

Frustration can be a major culprit in undermining our confidence level. Creating frustration can actually be a positive sign that we are pushing ourselves to achieve something new and challenging. However, we must focus on the progress and the path rather than the obstacle.





FRUSTRATION INTO CONFIDENCE

Because doubt inevitably creeps in when we are unsure of others and ourselves, you should work extra hard on any area of your game that you believe could be a liability. Work to help others when they are struggling. Make sure you and your team can count on all of your skills and mental preparation every practice and every game. If each player makes this commitment we will be a confident team that is tough to shake.

FRUSTRATION INTO CONFIDENCE

Prepare yourselves to the best of your ability. Confidence will grow naturally as our preparedness increases. You are a Division I athlete and, as such, we must be prepared physically and mentally to compete against and beat the best players and teams in the country. Respect everyone but fear no one. Believe in yourself, believe in your teammates, and work hard to earn their trust on and off the court.





COMMUNICATION

- “Effective Teamwork begins and ends with communication.” -Mike Krzyzewski
- It doesn't matter what our personality is off the court. When we are on the court, we will be consistently communicating and preparing to play in loud gyms.
- Communication includes both relaying and receiving information. There are two main functions on the court, and both are vital to any team's success
 - 1) Motivating/supporting your teammates toward a common goal.
 - 2) Creating cohesion throughout the play so six players successfully perform as one unit.

COMMUNICATION

- When you're spoken to by a coach or a teammate, acknowledge that you have heard or understood them. Even if you don't agree, it allows for further communication.
- This includes communication both on and off the court: all messages sent deserve a reply, even if it is a "like" or letting the person know you will get back to them later.





STIRRING THE POT

Don't let pettiness, drama, or negative attitudes slow us down in our pursuit. There is nothing worse than seeing a team waste an opportunity to do something special by becoming its own worst enemy. This is not reality television. There is no place on our team for "pot stirrers." Work to become a person who resolves issues with direct communication instead of inflaming the problem with back-channel gossip.

STIRRING THE POT

Below are eight hurdles that every team faces throughout the season. How we handle them can either hold us back or give us an edge.

- 1) Tiredness and soreness during preseason.
- 2) Lineups and starting positions.
- 3) Classes starting and time management.
- 4) Parties starting and social life.
- 5) Travel increases - road games are business trips, not vacations!
- 6) Midterms and stress.
- 7) October.
- 8) Tournament time – peaking at the right time.



POSITIVE CHOICES

- As a team, we are committed to reaching our goals, and that requires every one of us to uphold the standards that support our success. Just like storytelling and stirring the pot can hurt our team, drinking, smoking and going out excessively can be equally damaging to our team and performance.
- No one on this team, regardless of age, should be smoking nicotine or marijuana. Anyone who is under the age of 21 must also not drink alcohol or enter establishments that require you to be 21 & up. This applies both in season and out of season. Anyone over the age of 21 should still hold themselves to a higher standard, make responsible choices, and comply with all team rules that could impact practices, matches, or overall team readiness.
- Violations of these rules and expectations may result in serious consequences, up to suspension or removal from the team. Our goals depend on our discipline, our respect for each other, and our commitment to representing Creighton the right way.

DISTRACTIONS

- There are bigger things in life than volleyball, but those aren't the problems that most often distract teams. Once we enter the gym, we will leave behind all little problems, attitudes, and moods. That doesn't mean we don't care about each other's lives, but the team's performance cannot rise and fall with each member's mood.
- Across the country, teams are working to be the best they can be. All teams are exposed to various hardships in their everyday life (i.e. relationship issues, failed tests, annoying roommates, etc). Because these problems are inevitable, we must work to be the team that handles ourselves the BEST.



DEALING WITH HARD TIMES

Let's face it... everyone tells us college is the best time of our lives, but they forget to tell you how hard it can be too. Every college student-athlete or non-athlete goes through hard times. Going through these hardships can actually be good for us. It's important to remind ourselves that these feelings, although not enjoyable, will actually build us into stronger people.

Remember that you have incredible resources available to you at any time.





GETTING SLEEP

The studies are clear— consistently getting 8+ hours of sleep will help you prevent injuries, do better in the classroom, keep your weight healthy, and help your attitude and mood. Making this happen consistently— even on weekends—takes commitment and organization from you. It means prioritizing time between classes and using those 20 minutes productively. It means turning off electronics at night so your brain can wind down and you can fall asleep. You have to make sacrifices to be great!

GOING TO CLASS

JUST GO TO CLASS!!!

Sometimes it feels like volleyball is our life, but academics are our future. The reality is you are here to graduate and prepare for the next phase of life. Skipping class is NOT an option and will be handled appropriately!



OUR FACILITY

We have gone to great lengths to make DJ Sokol Arena, the Ruth Scott Training Center, the Jensen Family Lounge and our locker room places we can take pride in and call home. Keep them neat and clean so that all can enjoy. There should never be a time when we walk in and are embarrassed by the way they look. We are always taking recruits, boosters, and alumnae through, sometimes unannounced, and it's important that we keep it tidy.



SOCIAL MEDIA

- As you are aware of by now, your generation has grown up in a digital age where information is instantly available online. It also remains as a record whether you want it to or not. Information, pictures, and videos are only a search away, and we should be mindful about what we want to put out there for the world to see.
- With the advent of NIL, social media is now a means to promote yourself and potentially make income if you choose to. Think carefully what you want your “brand” to be. One post with drinking, foul language, polarizing politics, etc. may eliminate opportunities, so think before you post. Always check with compliance before posting in Creighton gear.



SOCIAL MEDIA

- Keep in mind you still are representing something bigger than yourself when you wear a Bluejay jersey. You always represent Creighton Volleyball and Creighton University, and will be held to high standard because of this. Any grievance about our team, teammates, coaches, playing time, refs, other teams, professors, or classes should not be done on social media.





SOCIAL MEDIA

Some general guidelines include: Don't take any pictures or allow yourself to be in any pictures doing anything that you shouldn't be doing with alcohol, vaping/smoking in a bar, etc.). When in doubt, don't post. Keep all team business within the team. Outside people don't need to know about any team issues (injuries, sickness, drama, etc).

SOCIAL MEDIA

Avoid posting polarizing topics—especially doing it continually. The adage of “stay away from politics and religion” at a dinner party rings true. We want you to form your own beliefs and opinions, but recognize if you are constantly posting things you could be alienating teammates and fans who respectfully disagree with you. Don’t post **ANYTHING** negative. Take your time to cool down before taking to social media.



RECRUITS

We work hard to bring in top athletes and great teammates that will help build on the tradition we all work hard to create. Recruiting is the bloodline of any program and is a year-round process for the coaches, who are working to bring in great people and players to be your teammates. When we have recruits on campus for a tour or a camp, we expect you to be available to meet with them unless you have class or another mandatory obligation. More than anything these young players are trying to get a feel if they could see themselves as part of the team. Remember when you were in their shoes and how you felt about the players that either blew you off or made you feel welcome.



PICKING UP LITTER

Everyone has their roles on the team and in the gym, but if you see something that can be done to help the group, JUST DO IT. This includes things like setup and take down for practice, making sure the locker room and bus are clean, etc. Create a culture of action and betterment instead of watching and complacency.



A wide-angle photograph of a Creighton Bluejays volleyball court during a game. The court is blue with white lines and the word "BLUEJAYS" in large white letters. A large crowd of spectators is seated in the bleachers, many wearing blue. The court is filled with players in white and blue uniforms. A large screen in the background shows the game. The ceiling is high with many lights. Banners hang from the ceiling, including one for the year 2004.

REPRESENTING CREIGHTON VOLLEYBALL

The best way to measure your true commitment is by checking your choices and understanding that every other person on the team will be affected by our decisions, both good and bad. As a member of the Creighton Volleyball team, you are not an average, everyday student. You are special, which comes with benefits and responsibilities. By accepting a position on the Creighton Volleyball team, you are committing to a lifestyle. We always need to be conscious of how our decisions could affect you, your teammates and coaches. Excessive partying, skipping classes, not getting school work done, staying up late watching TV, eating poorly—these things could hurt our team and pull us down. There are no babysitters in college, and it's on you to make good choices and understand the consequences.

REPRESENTING CREIGHTON VOLLEYBALL

- Everyone has a unique college experience. Think hard about what you want from yours: How do you want to interact with your teammates/coaches? What do you want to accomplish in the classroom? What do you want to achieve on the court individually and as a team, and how can we get there? We have the opportunity to do something special.
- Set Clear Goals, Work Hard, and GO JAYS!





**LEAVE
NOTHING**